

Proposal: Data Analysis and Storytelling Training

Nicu Calcea

Prepared for International Media Support (IMS).

About the trainer

Nicu Calcea is a journalist with 16 years' work experience. He leads SAMIZDATA, a data storytelling consultancy working with NGOs and media organisations.

Nicu has worked as a data journalist in the UK, writing for the *New Statesman*, *BBC News*, *Global Witness*, with additional work done for *VICE*, *Transport & Environment*, *infogr8*, and others. The team he led at the *New Statesman* won the "Most Creative Use of Data Journalism" award at *newsawards 2021*.

Before becoming a data journalist, he worked as a journalist for media organisations in Moldova, including *Publika TV*, *Privesc.Eu*, *Moldova.org*, and *RISE Moldova*.

Nicu also taught an "Introduction to Data Journalism" course at City, University of London from 2021 to 2025.

He has led workshops at international journalism conferences like *Dataharvest* and *Climate Arena*.

Approach

A one-day, hands-on training session designed to equip journalists with practical skills in accessing government databases, analysing data, and creating publication-ready charts.

The session will target journalists at the beginner or intermediate level. No coding background required, although basic familiarity with data exploration tools such as Microsoft Excel or Google Sheets will be expected.

The approach can be adjusted based on a short pre-training survey to identify the participants' interests and technical skills.

Participants will also receive a post-training resource pack with slides, tools, links to guides, etc.

Objectives

By the end of the session, participants should:

- Be able to find and navigate Moldovan government portals, as well as external open data repositories. We will also briefly cover some proprietary data sources that provide journalists with free information.
- Know how to clean, structure and analyse raw data, including with AI-assisted tools.
- Have a basic understanding of data visualisation, including what charts to use when. Participants will make their own charts using specialised tools such as Datawrapper.
- Learn good practices from data journalism projects published in Eastern Europe and across the world.

Format

The training will be conducted over one day, 10:00-17:00. It will be conducted in Romanian, in person. Participants should bring their own laptops.

Table 1: Rough session agenda

Time	Session
10:00–10:30	Welcome, introductions, and goals for the day
10:30–11:30	Using government and external databases
11:30–12:30	Data cleaning and structuring good practices
12:30–13:30	<i>Lunch break</i>
13:30–14:30	Data analysis and interpretation basics: common traps, how to spot the story in data
14:30–15:30	Data visualisation: what to (not) do and when
15:30–16:30	Group exercise: Draft a short topical story using real data
16:30–17:00	Q&A, further resources, discussions, wrap-up

The agenda is subject to adjustments as we develop the curriculum and based on the pre-training survey results.

Fee

The work will consist of 1 day of session preparation, 1 day of training, and 4 hours (half day) of follow-up support and mentorship.

At a rate of €400 per day, the fee for the training will amount to a total of **€1,000**.

If the training is outside Chişinău, the organiser will cover any travel and accommodation costs as applicable.